

The language of money

Normally, the government of a country is in charge of producing the money that makes up its currency. It oversees the making of coins and banknotes, in a factory called a mint, which are then issued through banks. Because it's authorized by the government as "[legal tender](#)", people can trust this money when it's used to pay for things. Each country has its own government that decides which unit of currency to use. So, just as different languages have evolved in different countries, so have different currencies, and people can use their money in exchange for goods and services within their own country. As with languages, there can be issues using currencies in other countries. If you go abroad, you need to have the money used in that country to buy things. For example, visitors to Paris from New York need to exchange US dollars for euros.

